Lizanne Jill Thornton

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Education

University of Texas at Austin

2023 to present: PhD candidate in the Germanic Studies program, Department of European and Eurasian Studies
Current GPA 3.82

University of Cape Town, South Africa

2021-2022: MA degree specialising in Linguistics.
Final percentage grade: 82%
Thesis title: *Kombuistaal innie Kaap: Investigating Gender and Language Change in the Development of Kaaps.*

2020: BA (Hons) in Linguistics
Final percentage grade: 77%
Thesis title - *From kombuistaal to Kaaps: Tracing transitions in identity through language use.*

2017 – 2019: Bachelor of Arts
Triple major in Linguistics, English Language & Literature, and German Language & Literature
Final percentage grade: 74%

Teaching Experience

August 2023 – present: Assistant Instructor at the University of Texas at Austin
Lower-Division Courses in German

Feb 2022 – Oct 2022: Tutor for second-year undergraduate students in UCT department of African Studies and Linguistics

Additional Academic Experience

March – June 2023: Facilitator in Writing for Postgraduate Completion Program
Provide writing support on academic dissertation/thesis writing for postgraduate students

Feb 2022 – June 2023: Consultant at UCT Writing Centre

- Workshop facilitation
- Conduct face-to-face and online one-to-one consultations with undergraduate and postgraduate students
- Keeping up-to-date online records of consultations

Administrative Experience

Jan 2026 – present: Member of the Advisory Committee for the Mellon Mays Graduate Program in association with the American Council of Learned Societies

Spring 2024 – present: Section Head for lower-division first- and second-semester courses in German Language Program

Jan-April 2024: Hospitality Chair for the Graduate Association of Germanic Language Students conference

Research Positions

August 2026 – present	Graduate Student Researcher in Second Language Acquisition and Bilingualism (SLAB) Lab
February – March 2023	Research assistant to Dean of Centre for Higher Education and Development (CHED)
June 2022 – October 2022	Junior Research Officer at University of Cape Town (UCT) San and Khoi Centre

Professional Development

12-14 August 2026	**Introduction to Python: Working with Research Data** University of Texas Libraries
23-24 July 2025	**Visualization of Linguistic Data with R** Department of English and Digital Linguistics Chemnitz University of Technology
21-25 July 2025	**Barrierefreie Kommunikation** Fachbereich für Translations-, Sprach- und Kulturwissenschaft (FTSK) Johannes Gutenberg University Mainz, Germany
July-Aug 2024	**Inclusive Course Design** University of Texas at Austin Summer School
23 September 2023	American Association of Teachers of German Biennial Conference Southwestern University Georgetown, TX

Publications

Academic Publications:

Thornton, L. (2026). Women and Kaaps. *Language Matters (Pretoria, South Africa)*, 1–25. https://doi.org/10.1080/10228195.2025.2590607

Gasparini, L., Shaw, D., Kathiresan, T., Borysiewicz, D., Stuart, GW., Cross-linguistic POS Consortium *, Vogel, AP. (2025) *Automated Parts-of-Speech Tagging in 52 Languages: Benchmarking to Establish Suitability for Multilingual Clinical Language Analysis.* [Preprint] http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5886229
[***Lizanne Jill Thornton** is a member of the Cross-linguistic POS Consortium and contributed to formal analysis (parts-of-speech tagging for Afrikaans), and writing (review and editing) of the manuscript]

Yu, M., & **Thornton, L. J.** (2025). Motivation of heritage language learning: Is heritage attachment enough?*Language Teaching Research Quarterly, 48,* 285-296. https://doi.org/10.32038/ltrq.2025.48.17

Thornton, L. (2024). Harnessing multilingualism at universities to increase learner comprehension. *OASIS Summary of Batyi, T. (2022) in Language Culture and Curriculum.* https://oasis-database.org/concern/summaries/02870x13k?locale=en

Newspaper articles:

"Women, the first 'kombuistaalers', ensuring the vitality of Kaaps empowering tool of agency." Daily Maverick, 12 April 2026.

https://www.dailymaverick.co.za/opinionista/2026-04-12-women-the-first-kombuistaalers-ensuring-the-vitality-of-kaaps-as-empowering-tool-of-agency/?dm_source=blocks-grid&dm_medium=card-link&dm_campaign=inform

Conference Presentations

24 April 2026	**American Association of Applied Linguistics Virtual Conference** Roundtable presentation entitled 'Review of translanguaging literature and the implications for German second-language learning'.
02-03 May 2025	**Germanic Linguistics Annual Conference** Presented academic paper 'A critical review of translanguaging pedagogical practice to facilitate learner motivation and comprehension in German second-language learning'.
22-25 March 2025	**American Association of Applied Linguistics** Roundtable presentation entitled 'Motivation of learning German as a heritage language. Is heritage attachment enough?
15-16 August 2024	**Symposium on Kaaps** Presented academic paper *'Kombuistaal innie Kaap (kitchen language in the Cape): Investigating Gender and Language Change in the development of Kaaps'.*
25-27 April 2024	**Germanic Linguistics Annual Conference** Presented academic paper *'The Relevance of German in a post-apartheid southern Africa (1994-2024)'*
19 April 2024	**UT Austin Graduate Association of Germanic Language Students' Conference** Presented academic paper *'The Relevance of German in a post-apartheid southern Africa (1994-2024)'*
22-24 June 2023	**SSRC Summer-Mellon Mays Graduate Student Summer Conference** Presented academic paper 'Kombuistaal innie Kaap (kitchen language in the Cape): Investigating Gender and Language Change in the development of Kaaps.
25-27 January 2022	**INTPART Summer School of Linguistics** Presented overview of proposed MA thesis research

Awards and Funding

2026	UT Graduate Recognition Fellowship
2026	UT COLA Graduate Student Research Travel Fellowship
2025	Däuble Memorial Fund Summer Travel Grant
2025	University of Texas at Austin Summer Excellence Fellowship Grant
2024	University of Texas at Austin Writing Fellowship Grant
2023	Social Science Research Council Predoctoral Research Grant
2022	Social Science Research Council Graduate Studies Enhancement Grant
2019	Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship

Professional Memberships

2025 –2026	American Association of Applied Linguistics
2024	Society for Germanic Linguistics